A-A-53609
11 August 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FORCEPS, MICROSCOPE COVER GLASS

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to Interim Federal Specification NNN-F-001643.

This commercial item description covers forceps suitable for handling microscope slides and cover glasses.

Salient characteristics.

The forceps shall be furnished in the following types and designs as depicted in Figures 1 through 4:

Figure 1	Type I	Mood Design
Figure 2	Type II	Microscope Cover Glass
Figure 3	Type III	Gooseneck
Figure 4	Type IV	Sharp Points, Curved

Type I, Mood forceps shall be of the self closing type, made of one piece of spring wire, approximately 0.078 inches in diameter, and conforming to the requirements of AISI 1040 carbon steel, hard drawn, steel wire, heavily nickel plated. Shall be approximately 4.8 inches in overall length. Shall have a loop approximately 3/4 inch in diameter at the closed end, one finger grip approximately 5/8 inch in diameter near the center length of each arm, and an integral guide loop approximately 5/16 by 1 inch in outside dimensions near the open end. At the extreme open end there shall be two jaw tips, the upper square cut measuring 0.078 inch in diameter, and the lower formed into an oblong shape approximately 5/16 by 5/16 inch in outside dimensions with the upper half flattened to form a level surface. Shall have an oblong shaped rest approximately 1-7/16 by 5/16 inch in outside dimensions, located approximately 5/8 inch below the lower jaw tip, which shall permit forceps to remain on a table without tipping, and to hold a slide in a horizontal position. Type I forceps shall conform to Figure 1 for style and design.

AMSC N/A FSC 6640

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Type II forceps shall be straight-tipped cover glass, spring type forceps fabricated from carbon steel conforming to the requirements of either AISI 1020, 1022, or 1023 carbon steel strip, having a Rockwell hardness of B-75 to B100 when tested in accordance with ASTM Designation E-18. Shall be of two-piece construction with the closed end being resistance welded. The welded end shall be smoothly finished. Shall have thin, flat, beveled or slightly tapered tips, and the finger grips shall be serrated with 32 ± 5 serrations per inch. Shall be provided with a guide pin located near the tips. The overall length shall be 4-1/2 ± 1/8 inch, and the maximum width shall be 5/16 ± 1/16 inch. The width of the tips shall be 1/8 ± 1/32 inch. Type II forceps shall conform to Figure 2 for style and design.

Type III forceps shall be the Gooseneck design, fabricated from Monel metal conforming to the requirements of ASTM Designation B-164, and having a bright finish. Shall be of two-piece construction with the closed end being resistance welded. The welded end shall be smoothly finished. The jaws shall be parallel and curved at the tips. Inside of the tips and the finger grips on the handles shall be serrated. The handle finger grips shall have 32 ± 5 serrations per inch. The inside of the tips shall have 60 ± 10 serrations per inch, 1/2 ± 1/8 inches in overall length. The overall length of the forceps shall be 4-1/2 ± 1/8 inch, and the maximum width of the finger grip shall be 5/16 ± 1/16 inch. The prong portion of the forceps which extends from the finger grips to the jaws shall be a nominal 1/8 inch thick. Type III forceps shall conform to Figure 3 for style and design.

Type IV forceps shall be a curved, sharp points type, fabricated from carbon steel conforming to the requirements of either AISI 1020, 1022, or 1023 carbon steel strips, having a Rockwell hardness of B75 to B100 when tested in accordance with ASTM Designation E-18. Shall be of two-piece construction with the closed end being resistance welded. The welded end shall be smoothly finished. The jaws shall be parallel and curved at the tips with a radius of 3/4 ± 1/16 inches. Inside of the tips and the finger grips on the handles shall be serrated. The handle finger grips shall have 32 ± 5 serrations per inch. The inside of the tips shall have 60 ± 10 serrations per inch, 1/2 ± 1/8 inches in overall length. The overall length of the forceps shall be 4-1/2 ± 1/8 inch, and the maximum width of the closed end shall be 5/16 ± 1/16 inch. Type IV forceps shall conform to Figure 4 for style and design.

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Forceps fabricated from carbon steel strip and carbon steel wire, shall have a plating of chromium applied over a plating of nickel over copper. The chromium plating shall be in accordance with Class 1, Type 1 of Federal Specification QQ-C-320, and the nickel plating shall be in accordance with Class 1, Type III of Federal Specification QQ-N-290.

There shall be no evidence of corrosion on the plated forceps when subjected to the following test: The forceps shall be scrubbed with soap and water, thoroughly rinsed in distilled water, and dried. After cleaning, the forceps shall be boiled in distilled water in a large glass vessel, for 30 minutes and allowed to remain submerged for an additional 24 hours.

Except for Type I, forceps shall be legibly and permanently marked with the name or registered trademark of the manufacturer.

Workmanship. The forceps shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One forceps, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Reference standards and specifications. Where standards and specifications are referenced herein, the issue of that standard or specification in effect on the date of solicitation shall be used to determine compliance with stated requirements.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any

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time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Inspections and tests. Inspections and tests shall be conducted in accordance with commercial practice to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for inspections and tests. Sampling for inspections and tests shall be conducted in accordance with commercial practice. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one forceps.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable. The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U. S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/ contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its

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subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

6640-00-359-9805	FORCEPS, Gooseneck	Type III
6640-00-426-0300	FORCEPS, Microscope	Type II
6640-00-426-0315	FORCEPS, Mood	Type I
6640-00-526-8306	FORCEPS, Curved	Type IV

Ordering data. (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

AGENT:

DLA-DM

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CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6640-1514

Location: Disk No. 13

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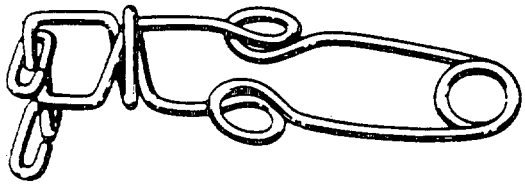


FIGURE 1



FIGURE 2

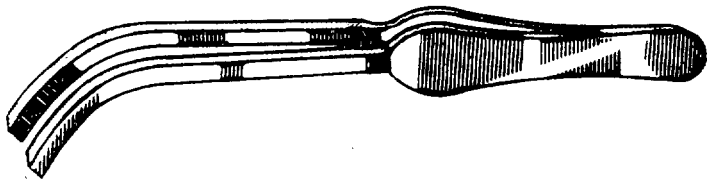


FIGURE 3



FIGURE 4

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